

There was a marked shift in the passenger travel experience as well. The pre-existing four passenger classes were discontinued in 1955. There were not many takers for the first class and therefore, there were economic disadvantages to running it. Hence, it was abolished. The second, inter, and third classes were renamed as first, second, and third classes, respectively. Even before this restructuring, efforts were made to alleviate the condition of third-class coaches by introducing sleeping facilities on some fast trains. Cleanliness became a priority for these coaches; in 1956 third-class passengers got access to the dining car, and by 1959 all coaches had fans and lights.



▲ **Towards the end of the 1970s**, the Indian Railways adopted AC two-tier coaches, followed by AC three-tier ones in 1993 when ordinary sleeper coaches were also introduced.